

Teaching Statement

Academic economists are well known for prioritizing research and grant work, while treating teaching as a tertiary assignment. My goal as an aspiring academic is to show that these goals need not be mutually exclusive. As a PhD student at NC State, I have had the rare opportunity to teach as an independent instructor several times throughout my program. I have taught EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics three times and ARE 201: Introduction to Agricultural and Resource Economics once. I received a 4.79/5 across all my teaching evaluations the first time I taught EC 202, and I received a 4.76/5 across all evaluations the second time I taught it.¹ When I taught ARE 201, I received a 4.49/5 across all evaluations.

As an instructor, I aim to prioritize critical thinking and eschew ideological indoctrination. As economists, we are prone to have strong feelings over the topics we teach in class. This is especially relevant in my macroeconomics class. Is money neutral? Are prices sticky? Should we prioritize fiscal or monetary policy to alleviate recessions? When teaching introductory agricultural economics, I always emphasize that the models of perfect/imperfect competition are not scripture, rather they are frameworks for understanding human exchange. While I have opinions on these issues, I make it a priority to teach the students all sides of an issue. My philosophy is that collegiate education should provide students with an arsenal of knowledge they can use to form opinions by themselves, without me telling them how to think.

I am also passionate about teaching so that all levels of learning are accommodated. Anyone who has taught a class at any level knows that not everyone learns at the same pace. Every semester, instructors receive a confidential list of students who need testing accommodations. I make it a priority of mine to ensure the necessary students can access these accommodations through the Disability Rights Office (DRO), often fielding emails between the students and the DRO to ensure they can properly take their examinations in a comfortable environment for them. Selected student comments that underscore this priority include “He cared about every student’s success and was very responsive to any issues with quizzes or tests,” and “Mr. Hoarty was a great teacher. He created a comfortable learning environment, going at the students’ pace so as not to overload them with information”

As an aspiring professor, I hope to continue teaching agricultural economics and expanding my teaching assignments to the realm of econometrics. Reiterating my aim of prioritizing critical thinking, I hope to teach both structural and reduced form methodologies, boasting the pros and cons of both approaches. I also aim to address the same debate between frequentist and Bayesian methodologies. I consider these preferences weak in nature; indeed, I would be happy to teach any economics related course, so long as I can implement my teaching philosophies specified above.

¹ I am currently in my third semester teaching this class in the Fall 2026 semester, so teaching evaluations are not available yet.